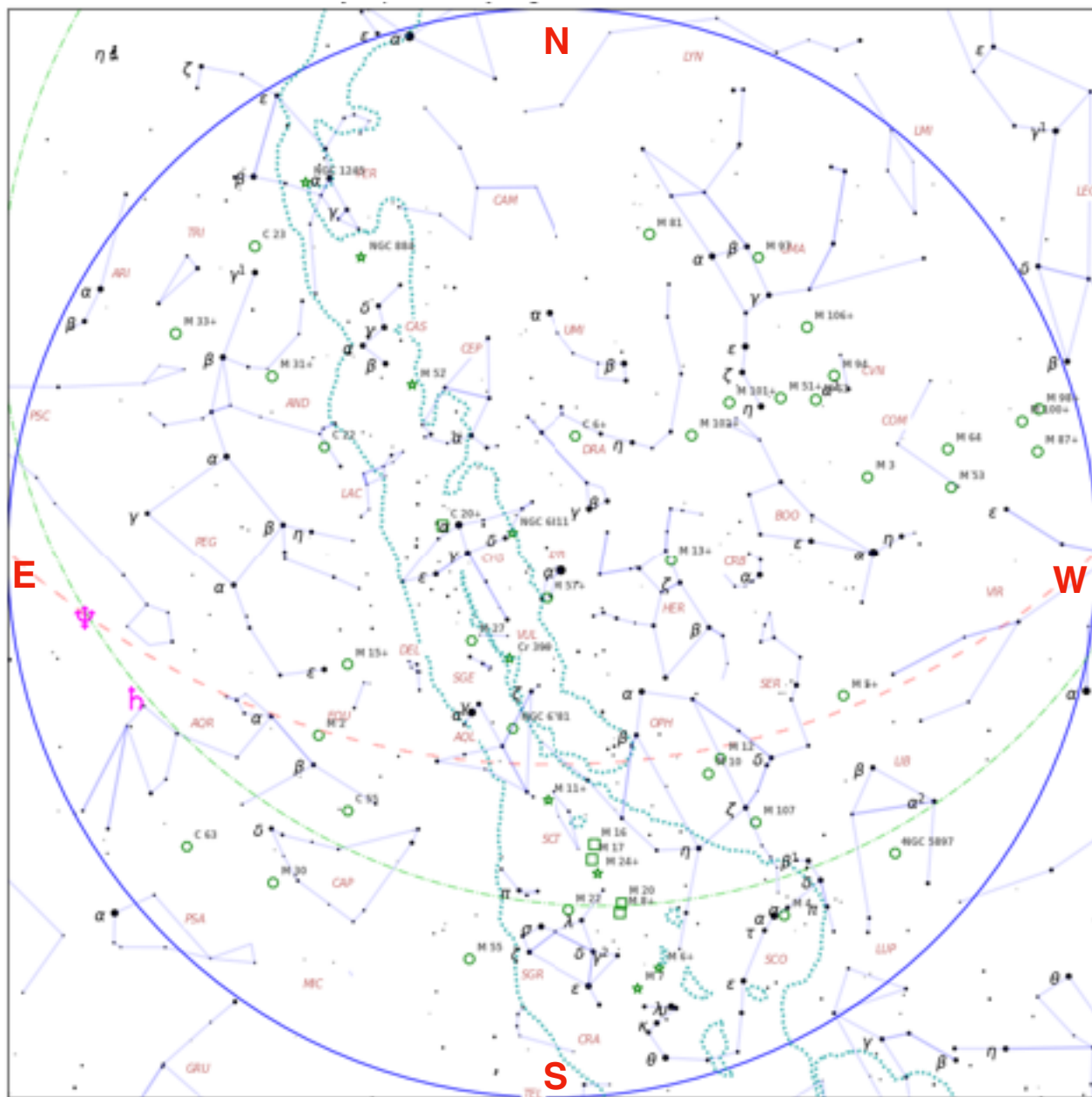


AUGUST 2024



The Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Meets the first Wednesday of every month, at the
North Adams Public Library at 6 PM.

74 Church St. North Adams MA

Under the Milky Way

Vega is overhead, and the Milky Way stretches from horizon to horizon. Scanning across the Milky Way N-to-S you encounter clusters and nebulae bright and dark all the way down to the Sagittarius and the center of the Galaxy!

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Maiden*
 AQL - Aquila - *the Eagle*
 AQR - Aquarius - *the Water Bearer*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 BOO - Boötes - *the Herdsman*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAP - Capricornus - *the Goat*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEN - Centaurus - *the Centaur*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 COM - Coma Berenices - *Berenice's Hair*
 CRA - Corona Australis - *the Southern Crown*
 CRB - Corona Borealis - *the Northern Crown*
 CVN - Canes Venatici - *the Hunting Dogs*
 CYG - Cygnus - *the Swan*
 DEL - Delphinus - *the Dolphin*
 DRA - Draco - *the Dragon*
 EQU - Equuleus - *the Little Horse*
 GRU - Grus - *the Crane*
 HER - Hercules - *Hercules*
 LAC - Lacerta - *the Lizard*
 LEO - Leo - *the Lion*
 LIB - Libra - *the Scales*
 LMI - Leo Minor - *the Little Lion*
 LUP - Lupus - *the Wolf*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 LYR - *the Harp*
 MIC - Microscopium - *the Microscope*
 OPH - Ophiuchus - *the Serpent Bearer*
 PEG - Pegasus - *the Winged Horse*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PSA - Piscis Austrinus - *the Southern Fish*
 PSC - Pisces - *the Fish*
 SCO - Scorpius - *the Scorpion*
 SCT - Scutum - *the Shield*
 SER - Serpens - *the Serpent*
 SGE - Sagitta - *the Arrow*
 SGR - Sagittarius - *the Archer*
 TEL - Telescopium - *the Telescope*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*
 VIR - Virgo - *the Maiden*
 VUL - Vulpecula - *the Little Fox*

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right. (Or if you hold the map upside-down and face North, East will be to the right, West to the left.)

On the chart, the orange dashed line shows the celestial Equator; the green dashed-dotted line the Ecliptic. The Milky Way is outlined with a blue dotted line.

Date	Time
Aug 1	11:00 PM (EDT)
Aug 8	10:30 PM
Aug 15	10:00 PM
Aug 22	9:30 PM
Aug 29	9:00 PM

Because of the Earth’s motion around the Sun, the time for this chart changes slowly over time, roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Planets

Saturn and Neptune reappear in the evening sky, low in the East/SE. Saturn appears dimmer than in other years, because the rings are getting closer to being edge-on to our line of sight - they’ll disappear entire for a few weeks in early 2025, but will present a fun opportunity in 2024 as they get thinner and thinner - something that won’t happen again until 2038.

Neptune, in Pisces, dimly shines at magnitude 7.7, requiring good binoculars to detect, and high magnification and good seeing to show and sort of disk (it’s only 2.4” across, so essentially “star-like”), but it’s bluish tint should make it stand out from the surrounding stars.